Breguet's Tradition line has always been the sort of watch that makes most modern dress watches look a bit timid. While others hide their mechanics behind polished good manners, the Tradition has long put the whole performance on stage, bridges, gears, balance and all. This new 2026 lineup does not tamper with that winning formula so much as sharpen it. The headline move is deceptively simple: Arabic numerals replace Roman ones on select models, Grand Feu enamel steps in where guilloché once held court, and the collection suddenly feels cleaner, fresher and far more current. That sounds like a cosmetic tweak, but it changes the mood entirely. The Tradition still looks unmistakably Breguet, rooted in the architecture of Abraham-Louis Breguet's early watches, yet now it has a touch more swagger and rather less museum hush.

The star of the refresh, to my mind, is the Tradition Seconde Rétrograde 7037. In white gold with its fully blue movement and white enamel dial, it looks superb, almost marine in spirit, like precision watchmaking seen through a sapphire-tinted lens. The retrograde seconds display is the clever flourish here. Instead of cluttering an already architecturally dense dial with yet another circular register, Breguet uses a curved sector that slips naturally into the layered composition. It feels less like an added complication and more like something the watch had been waiting for all along. The 7097, in warm rose gold, brings a softer and slightly more relaxed mood, while still keeping the exposed mechanical theatre intact. Then there is the 7038, which could easily have lapsed into jewel-watch cliché but does not. The black aventurine dial, deep black finish, diamond-set bezel and jewelled buckle give it drama, but the underlying mechanics keep it grounded in horology rather than ornament.

The other big conversation piece is the Tradition GMT 7067, and rightly so. Its green-gradient Grand Feu enamel dial, fading from pine green to black, is not merely decorative, it is a flex. Enamel is unforgiving enough in one tone; grading it smoothly is something else entirely. Add to that the dual-time display, a day-night indicator, and the option of Arabic or Oriental numerals for the Home Time dial, and you get a watch that feels both historically literate and globally minded. That, really, is the charm of this entire lineup. Breguet has not tried to make Tradition trendy. It has simply made it less reverential, more wearable, and much more alive. In a category that too often mistakes restraint for personality, that feels like a very smart move indeed.





